Configuring Rails Applications

This guide covers the configuration and initialization features available to Rails applications.

1 Locations for Initialization Code

Rails offers four standard spots to place initialization code:

- `config/application.rb`
- Environment-specific configuration files
- Initializers
- After-initializers

2 Running Code Before Rails

In the rare event that your application needs to run some code before Rails itself is loaded, put it above the call to `require 'rails/all'` in `config/application.rb`.

3 Configuring Rails Components

In general, the work of configuring Rails means configuring the components of Rails, as well as configuring Rails itself. The configuration file `config/application.rb` and environment-specific configuration files (such as `config/environments/production.rb`) allow you to specify the various settings that you want to pass down to all of the components.

For example, the `config/application.rb` file includes this setting:

```
config.autoload_paths += %W(#{config.root}/extras)
```

This is a setting for Rails itself. If you want to pass settings to individual Rails components, you can do so via the same `config` object in `config/application.rb`:

```
config.active_record.schema_format = :ruby
```

Rails will use that particular setting to configure Active Record.

3.1 Rails General Configuration

These configuration methods are to be called on a `Rails::Railtie` object, such as a subclass of `Rails::Engine` or `Rails::Application`.

- `config.after_initialize` takes a block which will be run *after* Rails has finished initializing the application. That includes the initialization of the framework itself, engines, and all the application's initializers in `config/initializers`. Note that this block *will* be run for rake tasks. Useful for configuring values set up by other initializers:

  ```
  config.after_initialize do
    ActionView::Base.sanitized_allowed_tags.delete 'div'
  end
  ```

- `config.asset_host` sets the host for the assets. Useful when CDNs are used for hosting assets, or when you want to work around the concurrency constraints built-in in browsers using different domain aliases. Shorter version of `config.action_controller.asset_host`.
- `config.autoload_once_paths` accepts an array of paths from which Rails will autoload constants that won't be wiped per request. Relevant if `config.cache_classes` is false, which is the case in